

FUNDAMENTALS OF PHILOSOPHY

COURSE INTRODUCTION

- It explores most fundamental questions of human life and universe.
- Philosophy addresses these questions through the human capacity to reason.
- Philosophical answers are based on logical arguments, which analyze and seek to justify beliefs.
- It helps to look critically at your own and other sides.
- Philosophy is a kind of investigation, in which you discover what you think, and then reflect on whether your opinions are really worth holding

Date: _____

Day: _____

Chapter # 01

Introduction to Philosophy

★ What is Philosophy ?

- The word philosophy comes from the Greek words 'philo' means love and 'sophia' means wisdom. So philosophy comes from the ancient greek words ^{→ philo and sophia} and literally means 'love of wisdom'.
- Philosophy is the study of fundamental nature of knowledge, reality, and existence.
- It involves critical thinking, logical inquiry and exploration of ideas and concepts.
- Philosophy builds practical critical thinking skills that employers seek such as i.e.... - logical decision making, clear persuasive writing, habit of questioning assumptions and the ability to understand complicated texts.
- Philosophy is the study of basic ideas about knowledge, truth, right and wrong religion, and the nature and meaning of life.
- Philosophy is like a compass that guides business in making decisions, setting priorities and

- creating value. It's the 'why' behind what they do.
- Philosophy is a systematic study of general and fundamental questions concerning topics like existence, reason, value, knowledge, mind and language.
- It is rational and critical inquiry that reflects on its own method and assumptions.
- Five words that describe and encapsulate the word philosophy are: ever-changing analytical, Morality, Historical and contemplative.

Examples of Systematic Philosophy !

- * Meta-physics , or the study of reality .
- * Ethics , or the study of what is morally right and good.
- * Epistemology , or the study of how we know reality
- Logic , or the study of good arguments
- Aesthetics , the philosophy of art or the study of beauty, taste and nature of art.

Why Philosophy MATTERS

Philosophy matters because it helps us make sense of the world around us.

Philosophy matters because it helps businesses clarify their purpose, values and ethics.

It guides decision-making encourages critical thinking, and fosters a culture of questioning and learning.

In short, philosophy is the foundation for responsible and successful business practices.

Philosophy matters because it helps us to explore fundamental questions about existence, knowledge, morality and society.

It challenges us to think deeply, ask deep questions, and consider different perspectives, which is crucial for making sense of the world and our place in it.

- Important point that includes specific reasons of Why Philosophy Matters •

- **Helps you think critically ***

- Philosophy teaches you to analyze information and make informed decisions.
- It helps you develop critical thinking skills which are essential in all areas of life.
- Philosophy teaches us to think critically and analytically.

- **Develops your Problem - Solving Skills ***

- Philosophy teaches you to approach problems in logical and methodical way.

- **Fosters a Deeper Application For Life**

- Philosophy encourages us to think deeply about the things that matter most to us.
- Philosophy encourages us to think creatively and adapt to new situations.
- Philosophy helps us to appreciate the complexity and beauty of life.

- **Increases self - awareness ***

- Philosophy helps us understand ourself and our place in the world.
- Philosophy inspires us to reflect on our values and goals.

Date: _____

Day: _____

PHILOSOPHICAL TERRAIN

- "Philosophical terrain" refers to the different areas or topics that philosophy explores.
- Just like a physical landscape has mountains, valleys and plains, the philosophical terrain is made up of different ideas and questions about life, know^{ledge}-reality, ethics, and more.
- It's the 'mental landscape' where philosophers think about big questions, like "What is the meaning of life?" or "What is real?"
- It refers to the broad range of subjects that philosopher study and debate.
- It includes everything from fundamental questions about existence, knowledge, morality, mind, to specific areas like political philosophy, metaphysics^{and} epistemology.

Socratic Method

The Socratic method is a questioning technique that encourages critical thinking by asking a series of probing questions to explore complex ideas and expose assumptions.

It involves asking a series of probing questions to challenge and clarify thoughts, ideas, and beliefs.

Socratic method is a way of learning and understanding ideas that was developed by the ancient Greek philosopher "Socrates".

Instead of just giving answers, Socrates would ask a series of deep thought-provoking questions to help people think more clearly about their beliefs.

* **Why did Socrates use questions instead of giving answers?**

- Socrates believed that simply giving answers to people's questions wouldn't help them truly understand the ideas being discussed. Instead,
- He thought it was better to guide them to discover the answers themselves.

Why is questioning so important in Socratic Method?

- The key to the Socratic method is the idea by asking questions, you can reveal contradictions or inconsistencies in someone's beliefs.
- People often think they know what something means, but their ideas might not be fully thought through.
- Through questioning, Socrates helped them see these flaws in their thinking and led them to reconsider their views in a more thoughtful and logical way.

What is the goal of Socratic method?

- The ultimate goal of Socratic method is to help people achieve **self knowledge** and realize the limits of their understanding.
- Socrates often said "I know that I know nothing" meaning that he believed true wisdom comes from realizing that we don't have all the answers.
- Through Socratic method, the person being questioned would hopefully come to the realization that they need to keep questioning and searching for deeper understanding.

Can Socratic method be used in modern life?

- Yes Socratic method is still used today especially in education, law and philosophy.
- In classrooms, teachers often use Socratic questioning to get students to think critically about concepts.
- In law, lawyers and judges use questioning to uncover the truth.
- Even in everyday life everyday life, you can use Socratic questioning to help you think more clearly about decisions and beliefs.

Does Socratic method always give clear answers?

- No, the Socratic method doesn't always give clear answers right ^{away} ~~away~~.
- In fact Socrates often ended conversations with more questions than answers.
- The idea was that by asking the right questions people could arrive at better, more thoughtful conclusions were not immediate or clear cut. The process of questioning itself was meant to lead people to deeper insights.